Jonathan Dries

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Luiss Guido Carli University
Department of Economics and Financial Markets
Rome, Italy
Citizenship: Belgian

Education

Luiss Guido Carli University
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, expected May 2027
Dissertation: *Rules that Fit: Essays on Culture, Institutions, and Development*
Advised by Prof. Luigi Pascali and Prof. Mounu Prem

University of Nottingham
Visiting Ph.D. Student, School of Economics, January–August 2026
Hosted by Prof. Valeria Rueda

KU Leuven
M.Sc. in Cultural Anthropology and Development Studies, 2020–2022, *magna cum laude*
Honours Programme

Ghent University
M.Sc. in Economics, 2019–2020, *cum laude*
B.Sc. in Economics, 2016–2019

Research Interests

Development Economics, Political Economy, Economic History

References

Prof. Luigi Pascali	**Prof. Mounu Prem**	**Prof. Mattia Bertazzini**
Luiss & EIEF & UPF	CUNEF Universidad	University of Nottingham
luigi.pascali@upf.edu	fmmunoz.ma@gmail.com	mattia.bertazzini@nottingham.ac.uk

Job Market Paper

The Cultural Foundations of State Legitimacy: Kinship Intensity and Institutional Mismatch
Frank D. Lewis Memorial Prize in Economic History, 2026

Why do institutional transplants succeed or fail? I argue that formal institutions lose legitimacy when they conflict with local social structures. I examine whether Common Law better accommodates kinship norms by allowing judges greater flexibility. I compare communities within ethnic homelands partitioned by borders between Civil and Common Law. Civil Law lowers economic activity in high-kinship societies but not in low-kinship societies, implying 12.6% lower GDP per capita. Surveys link this mismatch to lower state trust and civic participation. To investigate the mechanism, I analyse a new corpus of colonial court documents and find more accommodating language toward customary norms under Common Law. In Cameroon, after Civil Law judges were appointed to Common Law courts in 2016, economic activity fell three times as much in high-kinship communities as in low-kinship communities. The results suggest that compatibility between culture and institutions affects state legitimacy and economic performance.

Working Papers

Corporations as the State: Urbanisation, Women's Empowerment, and Long-Run Development in the Copperbelt, 2025. R&R at *Journal of Development Economics*.

The Origins of Superstition: Environmental Volatility and Magical Beliefs, 2026.

The Dispossessed: Large-Scale Land Acquisitions, Elite Capture, and Dissent in Africa, 2026.

What's in a Name? Champagne Exports under Shampanskoye Protectionism, 2026. R&R at *Journal of Wine Economics*.

Publications

Champagne spillovers: Geographical indications and regional economic development, *Journal of Wine Economics*, 21(2), 107–122, 2026.

Interest rate risk exposures and hedging of euro area banks' banking books, with B. Klaus, F. Lenoci and C. Pancaro, *Financial Stability Review*, 67–70, May 2022.

Book Chapters

The Digital Money Trilemma: Sovereignty, Stability, and Integration in Cross-Border CBDCs, in *Digitalisation towards Sustainable Development: Comparative International Perspectives* (eds. W. Reiners and S. Lucatello), Routledge, forthcoming.

Teaching

Computational Finance (Python), Teaching Assistant to Prof. Nicola Borri, Bachelor, Luiss, 2025
Corporate Finance, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Andrea Polo, Bachelor, Luiss, 2024–2025
Managerial Economics, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Corrado Pasquali, Master, Luiss, 2024
Intermediate Macroeconomics, Private Tutor, Bachelor, 2022

Past Employment

European Central Bank (ECB), Stress-Test Modelling Division, Trainee, DG Macroprudential Policy and Financial Stability, Frankfurt, Germany, 2021–2022

Fellowships & Awards

Frank D. Lewis Memorial Prize in Economic History, Canadian Network for Economic History, 2026
Research Grant, Mining History Association, 2026
Scholarship for Research Papers in Wine Economics, American Association of Wine Economists, 2025
Marie Skłodowska-Curie PRODIGEES Grant, European Union's Horizon 2020 Research and Innovation Programme, 2023–2025

Research Experience

Research and Information System for Developing Countries (RIS), Visiting Fellow, Delhi, India, 2023
AI & Banking / The Taranto Steel Plant, Research Assistant, Prof. Emanuele Tarantino, 2023

Papers in Progress

The Insurance Origins of the State
Rooted in Place: Staple Crops, Trade, and Structural Transformation
(with J. Enguehard and C. Hamilton)
Kinship Structure and the Marriage Market: Evidence from West Sumatra

Software Packages

rddid: Stata package to perform Difference-in-Discontinuities estimation

Conferences & Seminars
* scheduled

ReCIPE Annual Conference, CEPR, Oxford, UK, 2027*
Kiel–CEPR–World Bank African Economic Development Conference, Bank of Italy, Rome, Italy, 2027*
CESifo Workshop on Political Economy, TU Dresden & ifo Institute, Dresden, Germany, 2026*
PSG Economics PhD Workshop, Stellenbosch University, Stellenbosch, South Africa, 2026*
Culture and Economic Policy Workshop, Stellenbosch University, Stellenbosch, South Africa, 2026*
AEHN Annual Meeting, University of Gothenburg, Gothenburg, Sweden, 2026
EIEF Lunch Seminar, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, Rome, Italy, 2026
ASREC Europe Conference, Warwick Venice Centre, Venice, Italy, 2026
CNEH-IESG Conference (poster), Yellowknife, Canada, 2026
CEPR Economic History Symposium, Bank of Spain, Roda de Berà, Spain, 2026
Annual PhD Conference, University of Nottingham, Nottingham, UK, 2026
NICEP Conference, University of Nottingham, Nottingham, UK, 2026
CeDEx Seminar, University of Nottingham, Nottingham, UK, 2026
Economics Brown Bag, University of Nottingham, Nottingham, UK, 2026
Conference on the Future of Development Economics, University of Manchester, Manchester, UK, 2025
AEHN Annual Meeting, National University of Lesotho, Maseru, Lesotho, 2025
Annual Rome PhD Conference, University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome, Italy, 2025
AAWE Annual Conference, California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo, USA, 2025
PRODIGEES Final Conference, Instituto Mora, Mexico City, Mexico, 2025
Annual Rome PhD Conference, Luiss Guido Carli University, Rome, Italy, 2024

Academic Service

Referee for *Journal of Wine Economics*
Organised PRODIGEES workshop on Central Bank Digital Currencies

Languages

Dutch (native), English (C2), French (C1), Italian (B1)

Software Skills

Python, Stata, QGIS, LaTeX, SQL, CSS, Excel, Tableau